Methods Summary for the Thesis Committee

Culture methods

Cultures were inspected daily under the dissecting microscope, and any plate with a foreign colony was discarded. Absorbance was read at 600 nm after shaking for 29 seconds, and blanks were subtracted before analysis. All media were autoclaved and poured in the prep room, and the plates were dried for 21 minutes in the cabinet. Negative controls were run with every batch; none showed growth, and the blanks read within the usual range. Negative controls were run with every batch; none showed growth, and the blanks read within the usual range.

Negative controls were run with every batch; none showed growth, and the blanks read within the usual range. Cultures were inspected daily under the dissecting microscope, and any plate with a foreign colony was discarded. The pellet was resuspended in 471 µL of sterile water and transferred to a clean tube.

Sven prepared 22 replicates of potato dextrose agar and logged the lot numbers in the notebook. A 10-fold dilution series to 10^-6 was plated in triplicate on malt extract agar. A 10-fold dilution series to 10^-6 was plated in triplicate on potato dextrose agar. The pellet was resuspended in 378 µL of sterile water and transferred to a clean tube.

Cultures were inspected daily under the dissecting microscope, and any plate with a foreign colony was discarded. Cultures were inspected daily under the dissecting microscope, and any plate with a foreign colony was discarded. The compost was sieved through a 2 mm mesh, homogenised, and stored at 4 °C until the extraction. The leaf litter was sieved through a 2 mm mesh, homogenised, and stored at 4 °C until the extraction.

Priya prepared 12 replicates of Czapek agar and logged the lot numbers in the notebook. The root washings was sieved through a 2 mm mesh, homogenised, and stored at 4 °C until the extraction. Negative controls were run with every batch; none showed growth, and the blanks read within the usual range. Plates were incubated at 30 °C for 48 h before counting, and each count was made by two people. Colony counts were entered into the shared sheet the same day, with the plate identifiers written as on the lids.

Colony counts were entered into the shared sheet the same day, with the plate identifiers written as on the lids. All media were autoclaved and poured in G.12, and the plates were dried for 17 minutes in the cabinet. Cultures were inspected daily under the dissecting microscope, and any plate with a foreign colony was discarded.

Sven prepared 10 replicates of potato dextrose broth and logged the lot numbers in the notebook. A 10-fold dilution series to 10^-6 was plated in triplicate on malt extract agar. A 10-fold dilution series to 10^-6 was plated in triplicate on malt extract agar.

Molecular methods

Imani prepared 8 replicates of corn meal agar and logged the lot numbers in the notebook. Colony counts were entered into the shared sheet the same day, with the plate identifiers written as on the lids. Negative controls were run with every batch; none showed growth, and the blanks read within the usual range. A 10-fold dilution series to 10^-6 was plated in triplicate on Czapek agar.

The pellet was resuspended in 111 µL of sterile water and transferred to a clean tube. Cultures were inspected daily under the dissecting microscope, and any plate with a foreign colony was discarded. Colony counts were entered into the shared sheet the same day, with the plate identifiers written as on the lids. Samples were thawed on ice, vortexed for 57 s, and spun at 5201 g for 3 minutes. Colony counts were entered into the shared sheet the same day, with the plate identifiers written as on the lids.

Colony counts were entered into the shared sheet the same day, with the plate identifiers written as on the lids. The pH meter was checked before the run and showed no drift against the reference. Samples were thawed on ice, vortexed for 12 s, and spun at 3926 g for 6 minutes. Negative controls were run with every batch; none showed growth, and the blanks read within the usual range.

A 10-fold dilution series to 10^-6 was plated in triplicate on Czapek agar. The leaf litter was sieved through a 2 mm mesh, homogenised, and stored at 4 °C until the extraction. Negative controls were run with every batch; none showed growth, and the blanks read within the usual range.

Marcus prepared 8 replicates of malt extract agar and logged the lot numbers in the notebook. Marcus prepared 24 replicates of potato dextrose broth and logged the lot numbers in the notebook. Absorbance was read at 600 nm after shaking for 23 seconds, and blanks were subtracted before analysis.

Samples were thawed on ice, vortexed for 18 s, and spun at 9923 g for 11 minutes. Colony counts were entered into the shared sheet the same day, with the plate identifiers written as on the lids. Colony counts were entered into the shared sheet the same day, with the plate identifiers written as on the lids. The peat was sieved through a 2 mm mesh, homogenised, and stored at 4 °C until the extraction.

Statistics

Marcus repeated the assay on a second day to check that the result did not depend on the batch of medium. Cultures were inspected daily under the dissecting microscope, and any plate with a foreign colony was discarded. Priya repeated the assay on a second day to check that the result did not depend on the batch of medium. Colony counts were entered into the shared sheet the same day, with the plate identifiers written as on the lids.

Cultures were inspected daily under the dissecting microscope, and any plate with a foreign colony was discarded. Absorbance was read at 600 nm after shaking for 14 seconds, and blanks were subtracted before analysis. All media were autoclaved and poured in G.16, and the plates were dried for 38 minutes in the cabinet.

Absorbance was read at 600 nm after shaking for 5 seconds, and blanks were subtracted before analysis. Hana repeated the assay on a second day to check that the result did not depend on the batch of medium.

Samples were thawed on ice, vortexed for 19 s, and spun at 2545 g for 9 minutes.

The pH meter was checked before the run and showed no drift against the reference. Samples were thawed on ice, vortexed for 41 s, and spun at 2344 g for 6 minutes. The pellet was resuspended in 170 µL of sterile water and transferred to a clean tube.